

THE BLACK PANTHER

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EXCLUSIVE INTERVIEW

JOHNNY SPAIN ON THE SAN QUENTIN 6 TRIAL

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JOHNNY SPAIN (inset) survived the plot of August 21, 1971, when California correctional officials assassinated Black Panther Party Field Marshal George Jackson after creating bedlam on the first tier of San Quentin's Adjustment Center (above).

Incarcerated in California prisons since he was 17 years old, Johnny Larry Spain, a well-respected and well-loved member of the Black Panther Party, has lived and struggled to survive through the past eight years locked within the hell holes of the largest and most repressive penal system in America. For the past four and one-half years, since the August 21, 1971, incident in which he and close comrade George Jackson broke from the madness of San Quentin Prison's notorious Adjustment Center and dashed into the outer courtyard in an attempt to escape a vicious, preplanned set-up—only to have Comrade George ruthlessly assassinated as he lay helpless and wounded—Brother Johnny Spain has been chained and shackled in his every movement. Only when confined in his bare, 5' by 8' first tier Adjustment Center cell are the inhumane restraints removed.

Since May, 1975, when the longest jury selection process in state history began, Johnny Spain, along with five other Black and Brown prison activists, known collectively as the San Quentin 6, has had to endure a political frame-up trial, a scapegoat in the conspiracy to murder George Jackson and repress the growing prison movement. In the courtroom, Brother Johnny is again chained and shackled in his chair, separated from his friends and supporters by a specially constructed vision-distorting, bulletproof plexiglass wall.

Yet, despite all this, the efforts to crush the revolutionary spirit, the determination, the will of Johnny Larry Spain have failed. Brother

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